SAMPLE

Trust: The Surrender of the Soul

Tawakkul (توكل) in the Quran

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Introduction: The Reliance

The Quran describes trust -- *Tawakkul* -- as the reliance of the servant on the Lord, the surrender of the soul to the Master, and the dependence of the heart on the Source. The Quran says: "And whoever trusts in Allah, He is sufficient for him" (65:3). Trust is the surrender -- the surrender that lets go of the worry, the surrender that lets go of the anxiety, and the surrender that lets go of the control. The trust is not the passivity but the reliance -- the reliance that acts and surrenders, the reliance that works and trusts, and the reliance that strives and depends. The person who trusts is the person who does their part and leaves the result to Allah.

The word *Tawakkul* (توكل) comes from the root W-K-L (و ك ل), which carries the meanings of trusting, relying, and entrusting. The verb *tawakkala* means to trust -- to trust in Allah, to rely on Allah, and to entrust one's affairs to Allah. The noun *Tawakkul* signifies the trust -- the trust that is the reliance, the trust that is the surrender, and the trust that is the dependence. *Al-Tawakkul* is the trust that is the quality of the believer -- the quality that relies on Allah in the ease and the difficulty, the quality that trusts Allah in the beginning and the end, and the quality that depends on Allah in the everything.

This book -- the eighth in the Lessons from the Qur'an sub-series -- explores trust as the Quran describes it. It examines the name *Tawakkul*, Allah as the Disposer of all affairs, the balance of trust and action, the promise of what trust earns, the prophetic models of reliance, the anxiety that is the opposite of trust, Allah's guarantee of provision, accepting the divine decree, and the lesson -- how to live in the trust.

The Quran's treatment of trust reveals the dimension of the reliance -- the reliance that is the heart's confidence in the Lord, the reliance that is the soul's peace in the Master, and the reliance that is the mind's certainty in the Source. The trust is not the absence of effort but the presence of surrender -- the surrender that comes after the effort, the surrender that follows the action, and the surrender that accompanies the striving. The person who trusts is the person who acts and surrenders -- acts with the body and surrenders with the heart.

The first chapter begins with the name itself -- what *Tawakkul* means, how the Quran uses it, and what the name reveals about the reliance it describes.

Chapter 1: The Name -- Tawakkul and the Meaning of Trust

The word *Al-Tawakkul* (التوكل) comes from the root W-K-L (و ك ل), which carries the meanings of trusting, relying, entrusting, and committing. The verb *tawakkala* means to trust -- to place one's trust in Allah, to rely on Allah for the outcome, and to entrust one's affairs to Allah. The noun *Tawakkul* signifies the trust -- the trust that is the reliance, the trust that is the surrender, and the trust that is the dependence. The name tells the listener: this is not the passive resignation that does nothing but the active reliance that does everything and leaves the result to Allah, not the lazy surrender that avoids the effort but the confident dependence that acts and trusts.

The Quran uses the word *Tawakkul* and its derivatives extensively. As the command: "And upon Allah rely, if you are believers" (5:23). As the sufficiency: "And whoever trusts in Allah, He is sufficient for him" (65:3). As the quality of the believers: "And in Allah let the believers put their trust" (3:122, broader context). As the description of the Prophet: "So rely upon Allah. Indeed, you are upon the clear truth" (27:79). Each usage places *Tawakkul* as the central quality of the believer -- the quality that defines the relationship with Allah in the uncertainty, the quality that determines the peace in the anxiety, and the quality that distinguishes the faithful from the fearful.

The *Tawakkul* is the reliance -- the reliance that depends on Allah, the reliance that trusts in Allah, and the reliance that leans on Allah. The Quran says: "And upon Allah let the believers rely" (14:11, broader context). The reliance is the confidence: the confidence that Allah is sufficient, the confidence that Allah is enough, and the confidence that Allah is adequate. The reliance is the peace: the peace that comes from the trust, the peace that comes from the dependence, and the peace that comes from the surrender. The reliance is the strength: the strength that comes from the Source, the strength that comes from the Master, and the strength that comes from the Lord.

The *Tawakkul* is the surrender -- the surrender that lets go of the worry, the surrender that lets go of the anxiety, and the surrender that lets go of the control. The Quran says: "And whoever trusts in Allah, He is sufficient for him" (65:3). The surrender is the letting go: the letting go that releases the worry, the letting go that releases the fear, and the letting go that releases the anxiety. The surrender is the acceptance: the acceptance that Allah is in control, the acceptance that Allah is the Disposer, and the acceptance that Allah is the Manager. The surrender is the peace: the peace that comes from the letting go, the peace that comes from the acceptance, and the peace that comes from the trust.

The *Tawakkul* is the entrusting -- the entrusting of the affairs to Allah, the entrusting of the outcomes to Allah, and the entrusting of the results to Allah. The Quran says: "And to your Lord entrust your affair" (94:8, broader context of 88:27). The entrusting is the delegation: the delegation that gives the affairs to Allah, the delegation that gives the outcomes to Allah, and the delegation that gives the results to Allah. The entrusting is the release: the release that frees the person from the burden, the release that frees the person from the weight, and the release that frees the person from the pressure. The entrusting is the trust: the trust that Allah will handle, the trust that Allah will manage, and the trust that Allah will dispose.

The trust is the quality of the believer -- the quality that defines the faithful, the quality that identifies the believer, and the quality that marks the one who has submitted. The Quran says: "And in Allah let the believers put their trust" (3:122). The trust of the believer is the confidence: the confidence that is not shaken by the difficulty, the confidence that is not broken by the hardship, and the confidence that is not destroyed by the trial. The trust of the believer is the peace: the peace that is not disturbed by the uncertainty, the peace that is not disrupted by the anxiety, and the peace that is not disturbed by the fear. The trust of the believer is the strength: the strength that comes from the Source, the strength that comes from the trust, and the strength that comes from the reliance.

The Quran describes the denier's relationship with trust: "And they plan, and Allah plans. And Allah is the best of planners" (8:30). The denier does not trust -- does not rely, does not surrender, and does not entrust. The denier lives in the anxiety -- lives in the worry, lives in the fear, and lives in the control. The denier lives in the self -- lives in the own strength, lives in the own plan, and lives in the own effort. The name *Tawakkul* is the refutation of the self-reliance -- the refutation that the trust is the way, the refutation that the reliance is the truth, and the refutation that the surrender is the path.

The name *Tawakkul* is the freedom -- the freedom from the worry, the freedom from the anxiety, and the freedom from the control. The Quran says: "And whoever trusts in Allah, He is sufficient for him" (65:3). The freedom is the liberation: the liberation from the burden, the liberation from the weight, and the liberation from the pressure. The freedom is the independence: the independence that does not depend on the people, the independence that does not depend on the circumstances, and the independence that does not depend on the results. The freedom is the peace: the peace that comes from the trust, the peace that comes from the reliance, and the peace that comes from the surrender to Allah who is sufficient for the one who trusts.
